

Northstar Service source pack

All Northstar Service names, policies and values are synthetic training material. They are not a claim about a real company or a Microsoft tenant.

Executive context

Northstar Service is a fictional service organisation. Its leadership is considering a 30-seat Microsoft 365 Copilot pilot. No real customer records are included. The CEO requires a decision that names the business outcome, data owner, reviewer, measure and stop condition.

Current policies

- BRD-1: External customer commitments require human approval by the service director.
- BRD-2: A board recommendation must distinguish measured pilot results from assumptions.
- BRD-3: Confidential source files may be used only by approved roles; an unexpected Copilot citation triggers an access review.
- BRD-4: Unresolved high-impact safety failures require a hold decision.

Case facts

NS-21 - Risk appetite

- Business input: Five use cases with different consequences
- Expected decision artifact: Risk-tier matrix
- Named review gate: High-impact uses require stronger review
- Challenge to test: All use cases share one weak gate
- Outcome measure: High-risk use cases with owner

NS-22 - Incident response

- Business input: Synthetic disclosure near miss
- Expected decision artifact: Incident decision timeline
- Named review gate: Security owner determines escalation
- Challenge to test: Evidence is lost or blame is assigned early
- Outcome measure: Time to containment

NS-23 - Quality challenge

- Business input: Confident answer with two errors
- Expected decision artifact: Red-team finding and correction
- Named review gate: Release only after material errors corrected
- Challenge to test: Fluent answer is treated as proof
- Outcome measure: Critical errors per review set

NS-24 - Policy ownership

- Business input: Business, IT, legal and HR responsibilities
- Expected decision artifact: Governance RACI
- Named review gate: No control lacks a decision owner
- Challenge to test: Everyone assumes IT owns content quality
- Outcome measure: Controls with named owners

NS-25 - Board assurance

- Business input: Pilot results and unresolved risks
- Expected decision artifact: Board risk-and-control dashboard
- Named review gate: Disclose unresolved material risks
- Challenge to test: Green status masks a severe issue
- Outcome measure: Critical issues overdue